

Educated vs. Smart

Educated and *smart*, by the way, are two totally different things. Educated means you've gone through a formal training program and have completed the requirements for a particular field of study. It doesn't necessarily mean that you excelled in that field of study or that you showed any general proficiency for it. It just means you showed up, did the work, and got the certificate. Smart, on the other hand, means that you not only have some knowledge but you also know how to apply it. We talked about this in the introduction of this book. *Smart* is simply putting your knowledge and experiences to work for you—and anyone can learn to be smart. That's where the rubber meets the road, and it's why the world is full of smart, successful men and women who never stepped foot in a prestigious university—or any other university, for that matter.

I have known many educated, not-so-smart people, and I have known many uneducated, smart people. Between the two, I'll take the smart person—educated or not—every day of the week. You see, if you're smart, if you know how to apply knowledge to gain wisdom, you'll succeed in life no matter how educated you are. But no amount of education will make up for someone who is content to live an unmotivated, unknowledgeable life. Wealth will always seem just out of reach to that person.

Let me tell you what this looks like in a real-world example. I work with Dave Ramsey's company, Ramsey Solutions. We've become a pretty big organization, and we keep growing by leaps and bounds every year. As I write this, the company currently employs over seven hundred people in our Tennessee office. If you count those who used to work here but have since left, Ramsey Solutions has hired well over a thousand team members over the past twenty years. Now, with more than a thousand hires behind us, how much importance do you think we place on where a candidate went to college? None at all. That's right, even though we're a company worth over \$175 million and a nationally known brand, we've never hired a single